

Chapter 28 - Care

The time for Feng Yue's scheduled housewarming party was approaching. This was the first time she had ever cooked at home to entertain good friends.

So she took this gathering very seriously, and with the added pressure of filming video content, she felt even more nervous.

Recently, because there were some things about cooking and filming that she didn't quite understand, she had been in contact with Wen Zhen particularly frequently.

This also meant that Wen Zhen now could come to her home without giving advance notice.

Today was originally the day for Feng Yue's medical follow-up. She took the elevator downstairs, planning to hail a taxi, when a familiar car stopped in front of her.

"A-Yue? Are you going out?" The car window rolled down, and it was indeed Wen Zhen. Her passenger seat was piled with things wrapped in brown paper bags.

"Sister Wen Zhen, why are you here?" Seeing Wen Zhen downstairs at her residential complex at this time, she must have come to find her.

"I came to bring you books." Wen Zhen gestured with her chin toward the brown paper bag.

"Didn't you ask to borrow some photography basics books before? These are all ones I've read and thought were good. I brought them to you."

Upon hearing this, Feng Yue's eyes immediately lit up. "Thank you, Sister Wen Zhen!"

"It's nothing. But are you heading out now? I'll give you a ride—traffic isn't bad right now." With that, Wen Zhen leaned over to grab the bag of books and toss it into the back seat.

Feng Yue originally wanted to refuse, but seeing that Wen Zhen had already specifically cleared the passenger seat for her, she thought for a moment and opened the car door to get in.

"Where to?"

"The hospital..." Feng Yue didn't really want to talk about her illness, so she didn't say more and just gave the hospital's address.

Seeing her expression, Wen Zhen understood this was probably a secret for her, so she didn't ask more questions and instead started chatting with Feng Yue about other topics.

Wen Zhen's proactive change of subject undoubtedly made Feng Yue feel relieved.

Wen Zhen drove Feng Yue all the way to the hospital entrance, then stopped the car and said to Feng Yue: "Go ahead, I'll wait for you in the car."

Feng Yue paused in pushing open the car door. She had thought Wen Zhen would proactively go to the hospital with her. Now thinking about it, Wen Zhen wouldn't do something that would make her uncomfortable.

Feng Yue let go of the door handle, turned around, and smiled at Wen Zhen: "Sister Wen Zhen, come in with me."

Wen Zhen was startled, then came to her senses and nodded. She had thought Feng Yue didn't want to tell her why she was coming to the hospital.

But now it seemed that by proactively asking her to accompany her to the hospital, Feng Yue was planning to be honest with her.

So for all of Feng Yue's examinations today, including the final visit to see Professor Fang, Wen Zhen silently followed behind Feng Yue.

Wen Zhen's expression became serious when she watched Feng Yue go for her first examination. By the time she heard Professor Fang's diagnosis of Feng Yue, she couldn't help but feel sympathy and pity for Feng Yue.

Wen Zhen accompanied Feng Yue to get her medication, and then the two returned to the car.

Wen Zhen's fingers gripped the steering wheel tightly, not knowing how to speak for a moment.

"Sister Wen Zhen, don't tell Qiongqiong about this." Feng Yue said half-jokingly.

Wen Zhen nodded, then frowned and asked: "Did Yan Lin divorce you because of your illness? Did she think you were holding her back?"

Feng Yue was startled. She hadn't expected this to be what Wen Zhen was concerned about.

She laughed: "No. My situation with her is very complicated—it's not entirely because of my illness. But I was the one who proposed the divorce."

Wen Zhen relaxed her frown and nodded. "That's good. Then I'll accompany you to all your future follow-ups. Just contact me a day in advance."

"It's really fine, it's really fine. It's very convenient for me to come by myself." Feng Yue waved her hands.

Wen Zhen turned to look at her seriously: "I'll accompany you."

Then she explained: "As a friend, isn't this the time to step up? Besides, my work schedule isn't fixed—I'm quite free."

Since Wen Zhen had said this much, Feng Yue had no reason to refuse anymore and could only nod.

Actually, Feng Yue felt somewhat comforted. After the divorce, she had always come to follow-ups alone. Her mother had always said she wanted to come with her, but ultimately Feng Yue was afraid Mother Feng would worry if she were there.

With Wen Zhen deciding to accompany Feng Yue to all future follow-ups, the atmosphere between them returned to its previous harmony.

When they passed a supermarket, Wen Zhen stopped the car and turned to say: "Come to my place for dinner today. I'll make you something delicious."

Hearing this, Feng Yue was somewhat stunned. After today's follow-up, she indeed felt a bit uncomfortable and didn't want to cook when she got home. She had originally planned to order takeout, but now with Wen Zhen's suggestion, she felt a bit embarrassed.

However, in the end, the two didn't go to Wen Zhen's house or to the supermarket to select ingredients.

Because Feng Yue directly said: "No need to trouble yourself. Let's eat at my place—my home has all kinds of ingredients."

Considering that she might be more comfortable resting at home, Wen Zhen agreed directly.

Feng Yue led Wen Zhen inside. Before she could put down her things and get to work in the kitchen, she was directly excluded from the kitchen by Wen Zhen.

"Just rest well today. I'll make you a new dish we've developed at our restaurant. Try it and give me some feedback." With that, Wen Zhen pressed Feng Yue to sit on the sofa, thoughtfully handed her the TV remote, and then turned to enter the kitchen.

This was the first time Feng Yue had been excluded from the kitchen in her own home, and she felt somewhat at a loss.

She scratched her head and was about to stand up to go look in the kitchen when Wen Zhen, with her back to the living room, called out loudly: "Don't come over—the recipe for our new dish can't be leaked."

Feng Yue knew she was saying this to comfort her, so she obediently sat back down.

Wen Zhen had been to Feng Yue's home several times, and the kitchen was the place she was most familiar with. So she worked quickly, handling the ingredients skillfully and efficiently. Before long, a fragrant aroma wafted from the kitchen to the living room.

Soon, Wen Zhen's voice came from the kitchen: "Alright, dinner's ready."

Wen Zhen looked at the TV that Feng Yue had turned on but never changed channels, currently showing economic news, and smiled helplessly: "Were you that nervous? I wouldn't blow up your kitchen."

Feng Yue followed her gaze and embarrassedly touched her nose, coughing lightly: "Cough, this is my first time being kicked out of the kitchen. I didn't quite know what to do."

Wen Zhen patted her shoulder: "Then come try our restaurant's new dishes. Besides the head chef in the kitchen, you're the first person to taste them."

Feng Yue looked at the several dishes on the table—they had excellent color, aroma, and taste. She felt both honored and happy.

Feng Yue picked up her chopsticks and tried a dish. As soon as she put it in her mouth, she was won over by the taste.

However, these dishes gave her a different feeling from what she had eaten at Wen Zhen's restaurant: "Very delicious! But the flavor seems different from what I had at the restaurant before."

"What you ate at the restaurant was all made by the restaurant's chefs. I rarely cook at the restaurant myself." After saying this, Wen Zhen used serving chopsticks to give Feng Yue another dish. "Try this one too."

"Delicious!"

Wen Zhen smiled with satisfaction, patted Feng Yue's head with a smile.

Feng Yue chewed the food in her mouth, looking at Wen Zhen in front of her—wearing an apron with her hair casually tied back, smiling as she served her food. For the first time, she felt the sensation of being cared for by a friend.

The two had a very pleasant meal together. Throughout the entire process, Feng Yue barely lifted a finger. Even washing the dishes and cleaning the kitchen afterward were all handled by Wen Zhen alone.

After dinner, the two went to the media room to watch movies and pass time, chatting intermittently.

However, Feng Yue was probably too tired, so she soon quieted down. After a while, Wen Zhen heard her steady breathing.

Wen Zhen turned to look at the sleeping Feng Yue and gently brushed away the strands of hair hanging near her nose. Then she stood up, took a blanket from nearby, and covered Feng Yue with it.

Not long after doing this, Wen Zhen's phone rang. She walked out of the media room before answering the call.

The call didn't last too long. Soon, Wen Zhen returned to the media room. After thinking for a moment, she wrote a note for Feng Yue and set a small alarm clock for around 5 PM.

After doing all this, she picked up her coat and bag and left Feng Yue's home.

Feng Yue was awakened by an alarm clock. She frowned and opened her eyes to see the pitch-black media room. The movie had long since ended, the projector had returned to standby mode, and Wen Zhen was nowhere to be seen.

Feng Yue sat up from the sofa. The endless darkness enveloped her, and this feeling of loneliness—as if abandoned by the world upon waking with nothing around her—made her heart feel tight.

She reached out to turn off the constantly ringing alarm clock and rubbed her temples with a headache. When had she set a 5 PM alarm?

Feng Yue got up glumly and turned on the media room lights. Once the room was bright, she noticed there seemed to be a sticky note on the coffee table.

"A-Yue, I had an emergency at the restaurant so I left first. I set a 5 o'clock alarm to remind you to wake up and eat dinner—don't have a grumpy wake-up mood! —Wen Zhen"

Feng Yue pursed her lips, looking at this small sticky note in her hands. The heart-palpitating loneliness she had felt immediately disappeared. In its place was a warm current flowing from her heart throughout her entire body.

Feng Yue happily put away the sticky note, then tidied up the media room before turning to go outside.

However, before Feng Yue could enter the kitchen to cook for herself, her phone rang first.

Caller ID: Wen Zhen.

"Hello, Sister Wen Zhen." Feng Yue answered the phone with a smile.

"Awake?"

"Mm, thank you. And sorry—originally we were supposed to watch a movie together, but I fell asleep instead." Feng Yue scratched her head, feeling a bit embarrassed.

"It's fine. I had to leave early for something anyway." Wen Zhen said, then asked: "You haven't started cooking yet, have you?"

Feng Yue shook her head, then remembered Wen Zhen couldn't see her: "Not yet. I was just about to go into the kitchen."

"That's good. Don't cook tonight—take a good rest for the day. I made some dishes for you at the restaurant and already had them delivered to you. They should arrive soon."

Feng Yue simply didn't know how to thank her enough and could only keep expressing her gratitude over the phone.

"Alright, alright, it's nothing—not a big deal. Just accept your friend's care once in a while." Wen Zhen said: "Since you want to thank me, just make us... make me lots of delicious food at the housewarming party."

"Definitely! I'll let you try my specialty dishes then!"

"It's settled then."